Lesson 09 material: Reading: Festivals, with Reading Strategies

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 1: People and Places

2.4: Reading an ESL Reader: BC Festivals

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

All Together Now: BC Festivals

In places across British Columbia, people come together for festivals that celebrate the things that make their hometown special.

Figure: Vancouver Island

Every year, about 20,000 grey whales swim past the west coast of Vancouver Island. The whales travel from Mexico to the Arctic and back again. The whole trip is about 16,000 kilometres. This is one of the longest yearly journeys of any mammal. Each March, the people who live around the Pacific Rim National Park hold a festival to celebrate the whales' journey. The festival is known as the Pacific Rim Whale Festival. The whales travel very close to the shore as they swim north. This allows people to gather together to watch them from land as well as from boats.

Figure: Bathtub race in Nanaimo

On the east coast of Vancouver Island, you can spot mammals of a different sort moving through the water — people in bathtub boats! The city of Nanaimo is home to the world's oldest and best-known bathtub boat race. It started out as a silly event in 1967. Today, Nanaimo's World Championship Bathtub Race is a serious sport that brings racers and visitors from around the world.

(Picture: https://www.flickr.com/photos/ruthanddave/4728395626/in/photolist-8cQeJY-8cLVbt-4Y4BWZ-4Y4xGK-8c1XYX-KM7cN-KMi9D-KMi8F-eHvFJS-4Y8XJG-8cQfCJ-4Y4ymx-4Y8Yo1-8cQghw)

Figure: Dragon Boat Festival in Vancouver

Vancouver is home to another famous festival on the water — the Dragon Boat Festival. Dragon boat racing started in China over 2,000 years ago. It was brought to Vancouver during Expo 86. It returned as a yearly event in 1989 as a way to celebrate the many cultures living together in the city. The festival begins with a ceremony to awaken the dragon and give the people and boats the dragon's strength. Each boat has a dragon's head carved on the front and a tail on the back. The boat holds a team of about 20 people, who paddle to the beat of a drummer seated at the front.

Figure: Vernon

One of Canada's largest winter festivals takes place in the Rocky Mountains of British Columbia. It's the Vernon Winter Carnival, which is held each February. Some of the major events include a BC snow sculpture contest, sports using giant hot air balloons, and a parade. During the carnival, people can have a friend, co-

worker, or boss arrested by carnival cops who then throw them in “jail” until they raise enough money for bail. All money raised goes to support the carnival.

The festivals of British Columbia are a way for the many people who live here to enjoy nature, share a laugh, and learn about one another.

word patterns

When you see the suffix –er, –or, or –ar at the end of a word, it often means “a person who”

- A baker is a person who bakes
- An actor is a person who acts
- A liar is a person who lies

Words in this story that fit this pattern are:

- Racers
- Visitors
- Drummer
- Co-worker

The suffix –est means “the most”

- Fastest means the most fast
- Strongest means the most strong
- Lightest means the most light

Words in this story that fit this pattern are:

- longest
- oldest
- largest

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2.5: Reading Strategies: BC Festivals

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

One way you can build your reading skills is to build your vocabulary. Your vocabulary is the group of words that you know.

You can build your vocabulary by keeping track of words that are new to you. You might see new words in newspapers or hear them on TV. Find out what they mean. Then remember and use your new words.

Learning new words helps you because_____.

- You will understand more difficult readings
- You will be able to express yourself more clearly
- You will be able to retell things in your own words

Vocabulary

Identify which words below are new to you.

- Tradition
- Celebrate
- Journey
- Kilometre
- Mammal
- National
- Championship
- Ceremony
- Festival
- Sculpture

Open or print this worksheet.

Choose three words from above that you need not know. Add each word to the middle of its own "word" box on the worksheet.

Look up your three words in the dictionary. Sometimes a word has more than one meaning. The most common meaning will be given first. Under "dictionary definition," write down the most common meaning for your three words.

For each word, complete all of the other boxes on the worksheet.

Word Attack Strategy

Often, we can figure out a new word without looking in a dictionary. We can use our word attack skills.

One word attack strategy is to look for a suffix. A suffix is part of a word. It is put at the end of the word to change the meaning. In this section, you will learn about these suffixes: -er, -or, -ar, and -est

word patterns

When you see the suffix –er, –or, or –ar at the end of a word, it often means “a person who”

For example:

- A baker is a person who bakes
- An actor is a person who acts
- A liar is a person who lies

Questions

- What is a visitor?
  - A visitor is a person who _____.
- What is a racer?
  - A racer is a person who _____.
- What is a sculptor?
  - A sculptor is a person who _____.

word patterns

The suffix –est means “the most”

For example:

- Fastest means the most fast
- Strongest means the most strong
- Lightest means the most light

Questions

- What does longest mean?
  - Longest means the most _____
- What does oldest mean?
  - Oldest means the most _____
- What does largest mean?
  - Largest means the most _____

Use Your Strategies

Think about any festivals you have been to. What did they celebrate? What kinds of events were there? Now, reread the reading *All Together Now: BC Festivals* from the previous section, 3.2

Check Your Understanding

The subject of the reading is festivals of British Columbia. The reading is divided into six paragraphs. Each paragraph is about a different, but closely related topic

Find the Topic

- What is the topic of the second paragraph?

    - Whales
    - Festivals in British Columbia
    - The Pacific Rim Whale Festival
- What is the topic of the third paragraph?
    - Bathtubs
    - Nanaimo's World Championship Bathtub Race
    - Vancouver Island
- What is the topic in the fourth paragraph?
    - The Dragon Boat Festival in Vancouver
    - Dragons
    - China
- What is the topic of the fifth paragraph?
    - The Vernon Winter Carnival
    - Sculptures
    - The Rocky Mountains

Fill in the Blanks with a Word That Makes Sense

The following words are your word bank...

- Cultures
- Journey
- Jail
- Serious
- The Pacific Rim Whale Festival celebrates the _____ of the grey whale.
- The World Championship Bathtub Race started as a silly event but is now a _____ sport.
- The Dragon Boat Festival celebrates the many different _____ of the people in Vancouver.
- At the Vernon Winter Carnival, people are put in _____ to raise money.

Grammar

If we learn the rules about capital letters, we can help our readers understand what we write. You already know to use a capital letter at the beginning of a sentence. This helps our readers understand that we are starting a new idea. Here are some more rules about capital letters...

grammar rule

Use a capital letter for...

- Names of people
- Titles of books, movies, newspapers, and so on
- Places and landmarks
- Days of the week and months of the year
- Holidays and special events
- The word "I"

Why Do These Words Have Capital Letters?

Match each word to the correct capital letter rule from the box above.

- Arctic
- Mexico
- Expo 86
- Rocky Mountains
- Nanaimo
- March
- Vernon Winter Carnival
- Dragon Boat Festival
- China
- February
- Pacific Rim National Park

These Sentences are Missing Capital Letters

Rewrite these sentences and add capital letters where needed

- albert ostman said he was kidnapped by a sasquatch.
- ginger goodwin hid on alone mountain near comox lake.
- there is a movie about bill miner called the grey fox.
- are you going to the kamloopa powwow?
- yes, i am leaving on friday, and i will be back on sunday.

Writing

Think of a festival you know about. Create a poster or ad to let people know about the event. If you want to, you can invent your own festival.

Include:

- The name of the festival
- Details about the events
- The dates
- The address

You can make up the details, such as where and when the next one will take place.

When you have finished.

- Check that you used capital letters correctly.
- Use the dictionary to check your spelling.
- Hand it in to your instructor.

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